

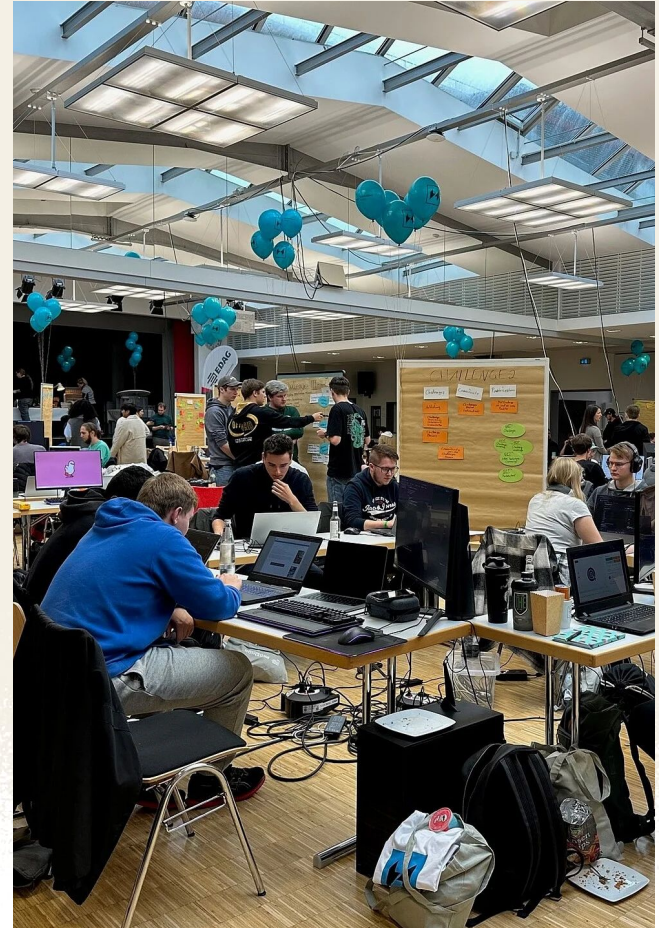
ASA DataFest @ UCSD Info Meeting

Save the Date: April 24-26, 2026

What is DataFest?

ASA DataFest is a multi-day, competitive hackathon for undergraduate teams. Participants work with a complex, real-world dataset, applying statistics, programming, and communication skills to uncover insights and present their findings. The event also offers networking opportunities with alumni and professionals, and awards such as Best in Show.

Founded at [UCLA](#) in 2011, it's now a national event sponsored by the American Statistical Association (ASA).



SIG x UCSD Team @ UCLA DataFest 2025

Sustainable Investment Group was honored to send a representative team for UCSD to UCLA DataFest 2025!



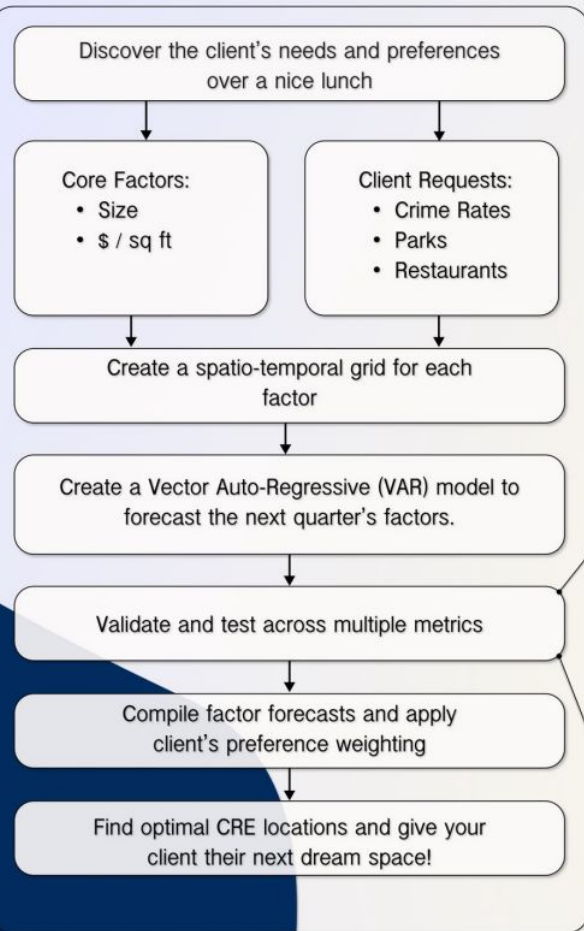
Where should x business ▼ want to put their next business?

Starbucks
REITs
Anyone

Statistically SIgnificant (B16)

Andrew Yang, Devan Velji, Sahas Goli, Steven Xu, Pranay Jha

Methodology



Case Study

A legal fintech company is seeking a large office in an up-and-coming neighborhood in Houston, Texas.

This firm prioritizes high walkability, low crime rates, and proximity to parks and restaurants.

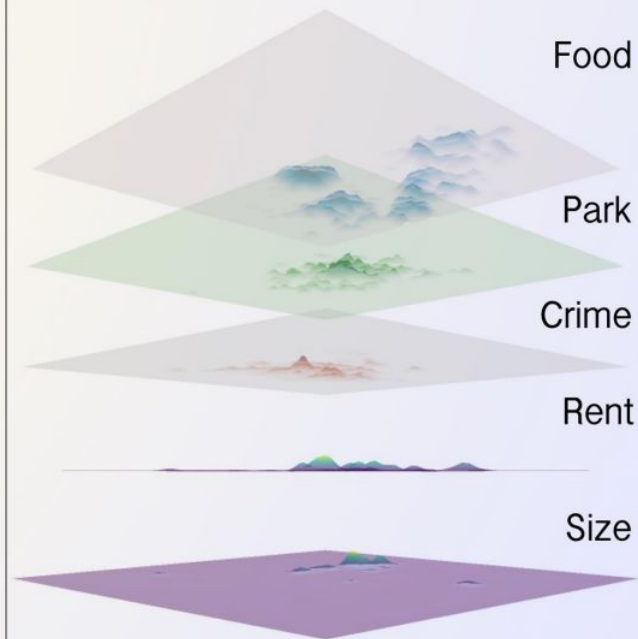
Validation

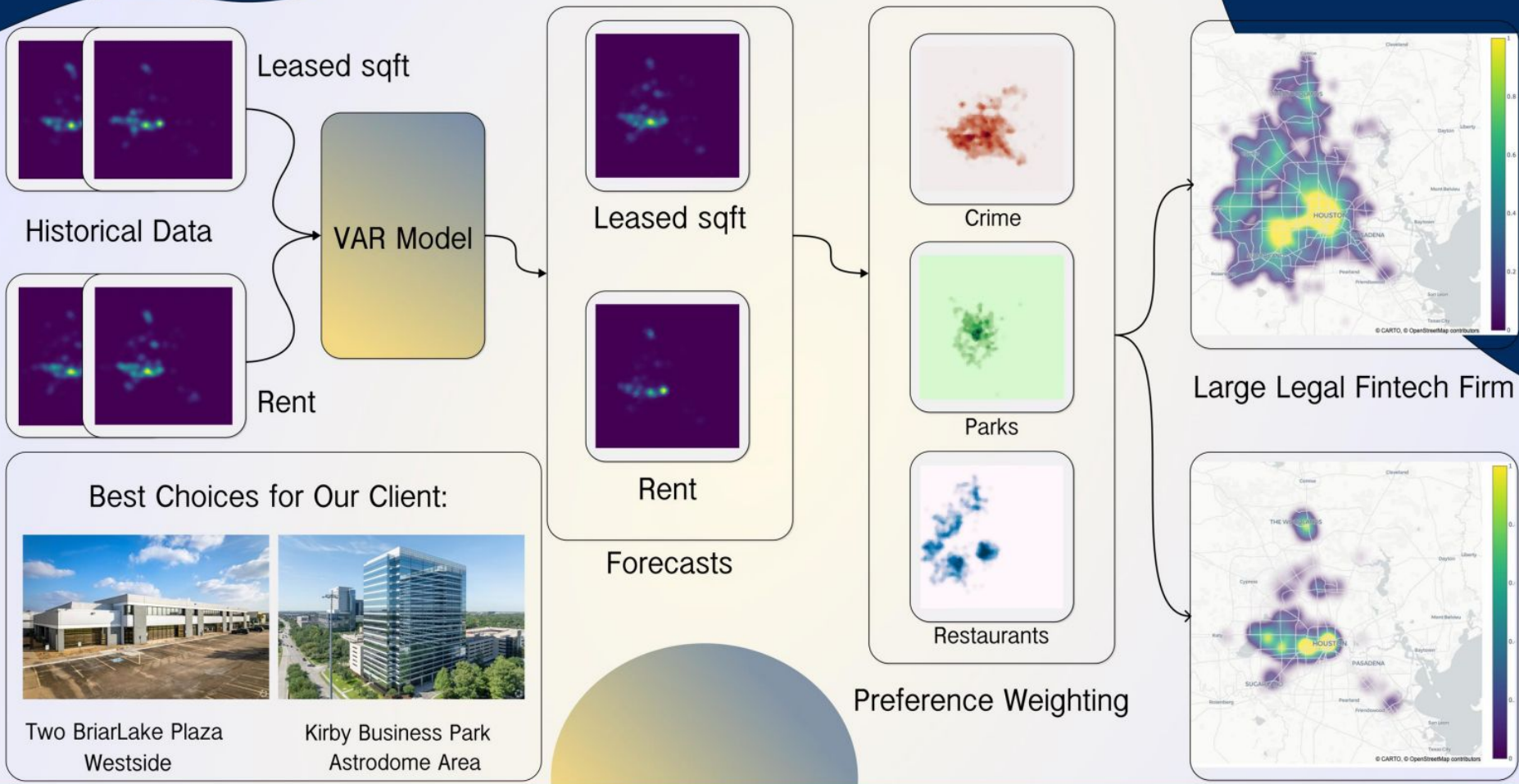
On the validation set, the VAR model performs better than our baseline model across these metrics:

- Cosine Similarity
- MSE
- Earth Mover's Distance

Factors

Layer Diagram





By fusing spatiotemporal forecasts with client preferences, we deliver a repeatable workflow for selecting the ideal next location based on a multitude of factors.

Arbitrary Company

ASA DataFest at UC San Diego 2026

Datafest 2026 @ UCSD is being jointly hosted by the Department of Economics and Department of Cognitive Science, in collaboration with student organizations, including Sustainable Investment Group!

Times & Locations:

- **Day 1 (4/24):** Price Center East Ballroom
 - Check-in starting late afternoon
- **Day 2 (4/25):** Malk Hall 5th Floor
 - All day
- **Day 3 (4/26):** Malk Hall 5th Floor
 - Event ending by early afternoon

What to Expect:

- Work with a complex data set from a real-world organization.
- Mingle with graduate students, faculty, alumni and industry professionals available during the competition to offer support and guidance.
- Present your findings to a panel of judges on the final day of the competition.

Datafest 2026 Workshop Schedule

- **Workshop #1: UES - Basics of R and Strata & Introduction to Data Visualization**
 - *Friday 1/16, 2-3PM @ CSB 003*
- **Workshop #2: DataFest 2026 Info Meeting**
 - *Friday 1/30, 2-4PM @ CSB 003*
- **DS3 - Data Science in Health**
 - *Thursday 2/4, 8-10PM @ Otterson 1s113*
- **Workshop #3: TQT x SIG - Introduction to Machine Learning**
 - *Friday 2/13, 5:30-6:30PM @ CSB 003*
- **DS3: Data Science in Finance**
 - *Thursday 2/18, 8-10PM @ Otterson 1S114*
- **Workshop #4: Blake Ellison - Working with Data**
 - *Friday 2/27, 5:30-6:30PM @ CSB 003*
- **Workshop #5: Presentation Skills**

Frequently Asked Questions

How many people are allowed per team?

Individuals are allowed to create their own teams, and each team will have 3-5 people.

Who is allowed to participate?

This event is open to all interested undergraduate students!

Do you need statistics and coding skills to participate?

It is helpful to have taking intro courses in data science, statistics, and coding, but communication and presentation skills are also important.

Students will work in teams on 3-5, so you do not need to be skilled in everything, but you should have a team with complementary skills.

Event Organizers

Faculty/Staff:

- Karen Doescher, Department of Economics
- Andrew Cronan, Department of Cognitive Science
- Emanuel Vespa, Department of Economics
- Xinwei Ma, Department of Economics

Associated Student Organizations:

- Sustainable Investment Group (SIG)
 - Jason Oliner, Co-president
 - Theodosia Lim, Co-president
- Undergraduate Economics Society (UES)
 - Jayden Wang
- Triton Quantitative Trading (TQT)
- Data Science Student Society (DS3)

If you're interested in helping to bring Datafest 2026 to UCSD, please contact any of the above for more information on how to get involved!

Get Involved!

Undergraduate Students:

Are you interested in participating in the DataFest competition? Fill out the student interest form to get notified when applications open for teams.

Graduate Students, Faculty, and Alumni:

Do you have experience working with complex data sets, and do you want to volunteer during the event? We'd love for you to join as a mentor! Fill out the volunteer interest form. We will follow up a month before the event to ask for your availability. We plan on setting up 2-hour shifts for mentors, and you can sign up for multiple shifts if you like!



Student Interest Form



Mentor Interest Form

Thank you!
Any questions?